calling “Hola, boys! You’re cute! Would you like to buy me dinner?” In the last frame, Griffy sits with Zippy over drinks, commenting “That was **not** what I expected! She **did** just want to discuss **Hemingway** & go **shopping**! Plus, she had a **degree** in **engineering**!”

But in the area of gender, too, the Special Period seemed to reawaken some very old patterns that the Revolution had sought to transform. Political scientist Mala Htun summarized the situation by saying “as the struggle for survival has grown more acute, latent social differences have been manipulated into justifications for unequal opportunities.”[35] “Because women are generally responsible for the well-being of the home and the family economy,” explains Julie Shayne, “they are forced into the position of making ends meet.” She quotes cinematographer Belkis Vega in a 1999 interview:

> This special period has weakened… the struggle of women’s revitalization. If [feminism] gets weakened because women are exhausted from the struggle of trying to survive… other struggles become secondary, because the struggle is one for food, of “How do I feed my family?” “How do I keep my house?” “How do I manage to provide my children with shoes and clothing?” And that takes a front stage role… The work takes up so much time that all you want at the end of the day is to watch a soap opera to disconnect, to evade things so you can sleep.[36]

The influx of the tourist industry and the dollars it brings has also offered different opportunities to men and women. The industry advertises the country’s women with seductive and demeaning images. And although both males and females have been drawn into the prostitution industry, the largest numbers have been among young women, especially women of color.

Cuban American Coco Fusco describes the *jineteras* she interviewed in the mid-1990s as “sophisticated traffickers in fantasy.” One of the women, describing how the neighbors viewed her business, replied “They see the *gallego* (Spaniard) coming in with a girl, and they don’t see him. They see a chicken, rice, beans – a full fridge.”[37] While emphasizing the women’s agency, she also concluded that “I felt I was